

Unit 5

E-Governance Master Plan of Nepal

The Government of Nepal last prepared a master plan for e-Government in order to keep up with the changing times the Government of Nepal needs to update policies and strategies that better reflect these changes. The citizens of Nepal have an increased capacity and appetite for services delivered via the internet and mobile phones. Businesses are better equipped and better connected to each other and their clients and need their dealing with the Government to be as easy and as fast, if not faster, as with their own clients. The rural areas of Nepal are better connected to the central Government offices by virtue of broadband internet that provide high speed and high quality internet services.

The E-Government Master Plan (eGMP) for the Government of Nepal was previously formulated by Korea IT Industry Promotion Agency (KIPA) working with the then High Level Committee for Information Technology (HLCIT) for the years 2007- 2011. KIPA had signed a MOU with the then High Level Commission for Information Technology (HLCIT) for the said task. The eGMP prepared by KIPA could not be endorsed by Government of Nepal (GON). The project has been revised on 28 February, 2013. The Rural e Community part of the project from the scope of ADB's ICT Development Project has been excluded from the project plan. With the changing technological scenario and changes in the national IT environment, the master plan needed to be reviewed and recommendations be made to strengthen it in accordance to contemporary opportunities.

e-Government Master Plan reviews relevant policies and regulations that may require update such as IT Policy, Electronic Transactions Act, National IT Roadmap etc. It also reviews and analyses the action plans that have already been implemented under the previous eGMP and the ADB ICT Development Project that funded most of them to look for areas that were

missed or may need change this time around. it also reviews in brief the changes: technological and regulatory, that have happened in Nepal after the first eGMP.

The main goal of this project is to achieve good governance and social and economic development by establishing effective, systematic, and productive e-government.

e-Agriculture, e-Education, e-Health and e-Tourism are four priority streams that have been specified in the master plan phase 2 as areas that have the most volume of demand for e-services from the Government.

After a rigorous review and analysis of the e-Government Master Plan 2007 – 2011 and analysis of the prevailing policies, acts and regulations concerning ICT and e-Governance, it is determined areas that required intervention and update and projects that need to be implemented for e-Governance to be successfully realized in Nepal. These are presented as the To-Be model of eGovernment Master Plan or the eGMP2(2015-2019).

The updated eGMP2 has been centered on three Ideas (Dreams): Effectiveness, Accessibility and Accountability.

- Effectiveness:

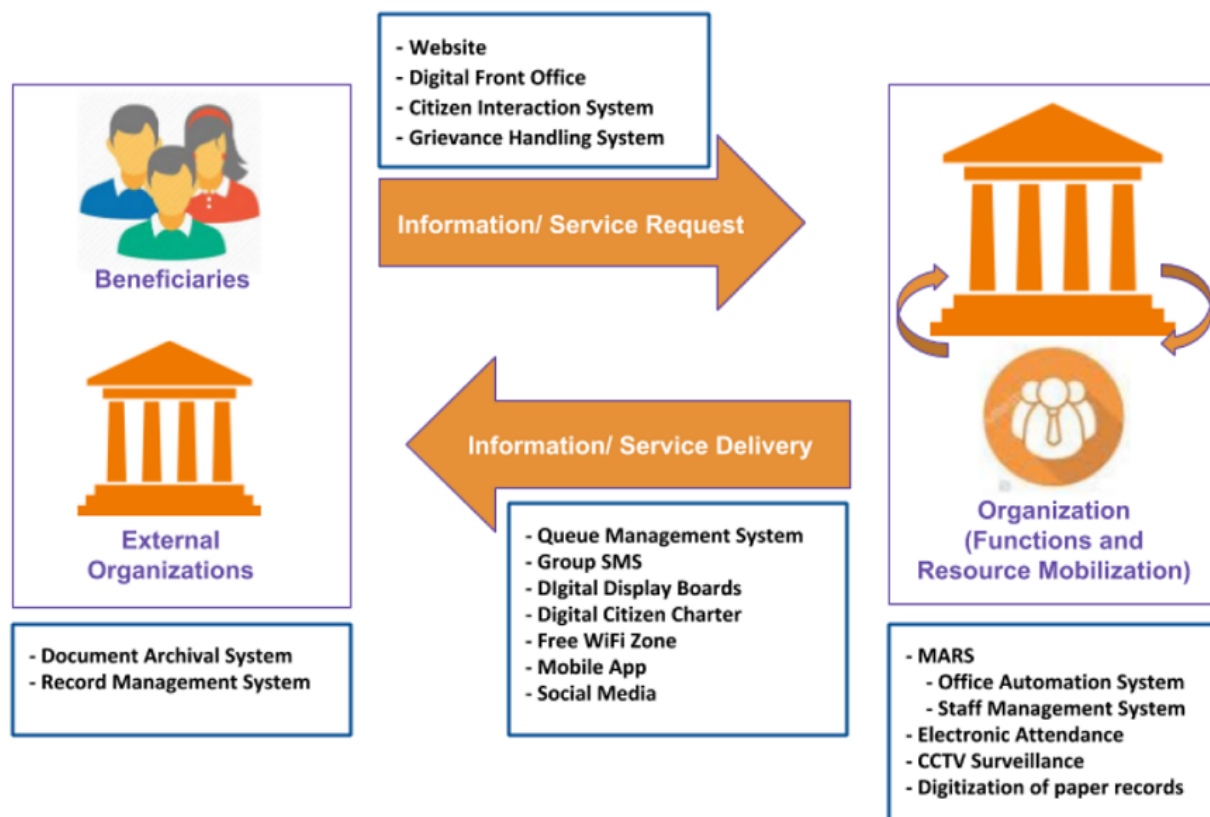
- All government offices will be paperless or use less paper.
- All government operations will use ICT as a tool to perform their activities to increase efficiency.
- All government organizations will share their data for decision making and will eliminate data duplication in different departments.
- All government organizations will aim for ubiquity, i.e. provide their service through e-applications, thereby removing the requirement of citizen to go to government offices.
- Government decision making will be based on correct, up-to-date information system of people, resources and their transactions

- Citizens/business access will be identified with a single Identification, i.e. there will be unification of: Citizenship Number, Voter's ID, Social Security ID, National ID etc.
- Accessibility:
 - Information will be at the finger-tips of citizens (from internet, mobile or any other new technology)
 - Any person (citizen/business/employee) will have access (web/mobile/any other new platform) to the Government services
 - Citizens/business will be able to pay taxes, bills and will be able to get required information via web portals (Government, Private).
 - All government, business and citizens will be connected to each other through broadband network
- Accountability:
 - All aspects of government institutions will be completely transparent. Information will be made available in any suitable electronic medium
 - Effective complaint logging, management & resolution system will be available

E-Governance in Local Government of Nepal

- Conducted in 2014 - 111 LGs with ICT Volunteer
- Indicators:
 - Website
 - Infrastructure
 - Software
 - ICT skills
 - Budgetary
- Scores - Kathmandu: 59.3 - Jajarkot: 23.8
- Ministry's effort to support e-governance
- In 2014 a new pilot initiative, "University Youth IT Volunteers"
 - A total of 141 Volunteers in all Local Units (then)
 - 8 UN Volunteers
 - 136 ICT Volunteers
- Purpose

- digitize the working procedure of government
- strengthen and maintain the IT Infrastructure
- capacity enhancement and promote volunteerism



Way Forward for Local Governments

A. For in-house efficiency

- ERP based Integrated System/ MIS
 - Accounting
 - Revenue
 - Assets
 - Human Resource
 - Citizen Interaction
 - Decision Support
 - Office Automation System
- Personnel/ Staff Management System
- Centralized Electronic Attendance System
- CCTV Surveillance

- Computer Networking and Resource Sharing
- Group SMS

B. Information/ Service Requisition and Delivery

- Citizen Support Desk/ Kiosk/ Booth
 - Online/ Offline Form Fill up
 - Citizen Record Management

- Mobile Application
- Website/ Web Portals
- Social Media - Digital Display
- Queue Management System
- Free WiFi Zone
- Digital Citizen Charter
- Grievance Reporting/ tracking
 - Grievance Handling System
- Hello Sarkar

Consideration for Local Governments

- Localization:
 - Localization of policy and applications
 - Contrast to unitary structure's 'One size fits all', we need change with localization approach- e.g Smart City, Need of Ramechhap MUN versus Bhaktapur MUN
- Bottom up modality
 - Citizen first approach. Understanding from the citizen's perspective
 - what they want has to be implemented.
 - Also, citizen needs to be made aware of services available.
- PPP Model:
 - A Government-led and Private Sector driven model has to be adopted. E.g NTA's RTDF

Nagarik App

Nagarik App Nepal is a mobile application launched by the Government of Nepal in January 2020. The app provides citizens with access to a wide range of government services, including citizenship verification, passport application, voter ID card registration, income tax filing, social security fund, citizen investment trust, and lok sewa.

The Nagarik App is a convenient and secure way for citizens of Nepal to access government services. The app is available for download on both Android and iOS devices.

Features :

- **Citizenship verification:** Citizens can verify their citizenship status and obtain a digital copy of their citizenship certificate.
- **Passport application:** Citizens can apply for a passport and track the status of their application.
- **Voter ID card registration:** Citizens can register for a voter ID card and track the status of their registration.
- **Income Tax filing:** Citizens can file their income tax returns and pay their taxes.
- **Social Security Fund:** Citizens can view their Social Security Fund balance and make contributions.
- **Citizen Investment Trust:** Citizens can invest in the Citizen Investment Trust and track their investments.
- **Lok Sewa:** Citizens can apply for government jobs and track the status of their applications.

The Nagarik App Nepal is a convenient and secure way for citizens of Nepal to access government services. The app offers a variety of features and benefits, and it is available for download on both Android and iOS devices.

Benefits :

- Convenience: The app allows citizens to access government services from their mobile devices. This saves time and hassle, as citizens no longer have to visit government offices in person.
- Security: The app uses end-to-end encryption to protect user data. This ensures that citizens' personal information is safe and secure.
- Accessibility: The app is available in both English and Nepali. This makes it accessible to citizens of all backgrounds.
- Updatability: The app is regularly updated with new features and services. This ensures that citizens always have access to the latest government services.

National Informatics Centre Network (NICNET)

National Informatics Centre (NIC) was established in 1976, and has since emerged as a "prime builder" of e-Government / e-Governance applications up to the grassroots level as well as a promoter of digital opportunities for sustainable development. NIC, through its ICT Network, "NICNET", has institutional linkages with all the Ministries /Departments of the Central Government, 35 State Governments/ Union Territories, and about 625 District administrations of India. NIC has been instrumental in steering e-Government/e-Governance applications in government ministries/departments at the Centre, States, Districts and Blocks, facilitating improvement in government services, wider transparency, promoting decentralized planning and management, resulting in better efficiency and accountability to the people of India.

"Informatics-led-development" programme of the government has been spearheaded by NIC to derive competitive advantage by implementing ICT applications in social & public administration. The following major activities are being undertaken:

- Setting up of ICT Infrastructure
- Implementation of National and State Level e-Governance Projects
- Products and Services
- Consultancy to the government departments
- Research and Development
- Capacity Building

During the last three decades, NIC has implemented many "network centric" application software for Programme implementation in various ministries and departments, using state-of-the-technology software tools. During 1980s and early part of 1990s, the policy thrust was on creating "Management Information System (MIS)" and "Decision Support System (DSS)" for development , planning and responsive administration in governments which led to the origin of present day "e-Governance" / "e-Government". "Bridging the Digital Divide", "Social and Financial Inclusion through ICT" and "Reaching- the-Unreached" concepts were tried and made operational in the late nineties. NIC has vast expertise and experience in the design, development and operationalisation of various e-Government projects in the areas of Public Administration and Governance like Agriculture & Food, Animal Husbandry, Fisheries, Forestry & Environment, Industry, Health, Education, Budget and Treasury, Fiscal Resources, Transport, Water Resources, Court Management, Rural Development, Land Records and Property registration, Culture & Tourism, Import & Exports facilitation, Social Welfare Services, Micro-level Planning, etc. With increasing awareness leading to demand and availability of ICT infrastructure with better capacities and programme framework, the governance space in the country witnessed a new round of projects and products, covering the entire spectrum of e-Governance including G2C, G2B, G2G, with emphasis on service delivery.

NIC has set up state-of-the-art ICT infrastructure consisting of National and state Data Centres to manage the information systems and websites of Central Ministries/Departments, Disaster Recovery Centres, Network Operations facility to manage heterogeneous networks spread across Bhawans, States and Districts, Certifying Authority, Video-Conferencing and capacity building across the country. National Knowledge Network (NKN) has been set up to connect institutions/organizations carrying out research and development, Higher Education and Governance with speed of the order of multi Gigabits per second. Further, State Government secretariats are connected to the Central Government by very high speed links on Optical Fibre Cable (OFC). Districts are connected to respective State capitals through leased lines.

The NIC offers a host of services including:

- Computer-aided design (CAD)
- Digital-signature certification

- Geographical-information system (GIS)
- Domain-name registration for gov.in and nic.in
- Informatics
 - Biomedical informatics
 - Patent informatics
 - Rural informatics
- Internet data centre (IDC)
- Mathematical modeling and simulation
- Computer networking
- Office-procedure automation (OPA)
- Training
- Cyber Security
- Videoconferencing=
- Website hosting & website development

Various initiatives like Government eProcurement System(GePNIC), Office Management Software (eOffice), Hospital Management System (eHospital), Government Financial Accounting Information System (eLekha), etc. have been taken up which are replicable in various Government organizations.

Thus, NIC, a small program started by the external stimulus of an UNDP project, in the early 1970s, became fully functional in 1977 and since then has grown with tremendous momentum to become one of India's major S&T; organizations promoting informatics led development. This has helped to guide in the required transformation in government to capably meet the challenges of the new millennium.

Computer-aided Administration of Registration Department (CARD)

Computer-aided Administration of Registration Department (CARD) project has brought about computerized counters at land registration offices throughout Andhra Pradesh. The state had a flourishing business of brokers and middlemen who exploited citizens selling or buying property. The CARD project is an attempt to reform this system through the use of IT. With the introduction of CARD, citizens now complete registration formalities within a few hours. The CARD project illustrates some of the key implementation issues the state and national governments may face in their efforts to use IT to improve citizen-government interfaces and serves as a best practice to be replicated by them.

The manual system in all the activities caused long delays, red-tape and corrupt practices. The project aimed at altering the antiquated procedures that had governed the registration system of the state, which included the laborious copying, and indexing of documents as well as their unscientific space consuming preservation in ill-maintained backrooms. The CARD project is an attempt to reform this system.

The CARD project aims at providing improved quality of services at the registration department by providing a computer interface between citizens and government. The tedious procedures that took weeks have been replaced by a system that can be accomplished in just a few minutes. The market value assistance and issue of the Encumbrance Certificate (EC) takes five minutes each. The sale of stamp papers, document writing and registration of the documents takes ten minutes, thirty minutes and one hour respectively.

Goals of CARD

- To simplify the registration procedure.
- To enhance the speed, reliability and consistency of the system.
- To provide transparency in valuation.
- To replace copying/filing systems with imaging.
- To preserve documents on CDs.
- To automate all back-office functions.
- To enable a system that enables setting time and quality standards.
- To smoothen the government-citizen interface

Collectorate

- Collectorate 2000 is a program of the National Informatics Centre (NIC) to design, develop and install a new suite of software modules for use in the computerization of Collectorates. This case study surveys the background, features, and capabilities of the software modules used in the computerization of Collectorates in Andhra Pradesh.
- During the late 1980s, NIC took up the NICNET program for implementing the All India Satellite-based Government Informatics Network connecting various District Collectorates, State Government Secretariat, and Central Government Offices in Delhi through a VSAT based network called NICNET.
- In 1988, VSATs have been installed (C200 model) in all District Collectorates with a speed of 1.2 kbps along with one computer system and two Technical Officers of NIC. Subsequently, in the mid 1990s, the NICNET facility was enhanced with IPA/FTDMA VSAT Earth Station with a speed of 64 kbps (shared) for Internet browsing purposes in the Collectorate.

Functions of the Collectorate:

- encompassing the revenue functions,
- land-related matters and the magisterial
- functions dealing with Law and Order, Arms Licenses, etc.,
- Welfare schemes, relief, and rehabilitation

Smart Nagarpalika

The urban local bodies in the towns and cities of the country are autonomous and are managed by elected representatives. These bodies, also known as Municipalities, are responsible for the management and upkeep of the civic amenities in the town or the city. For this purpose, they collect taxes such as property tax, water tax, etc. which form the revenue for the local body/municipality. In addition, the local body is also responsible for the registration of births and deaths, and the issue of building permissions and trade licenses. Following is the comprehensive list of functions executed by the municipality/local body:

- Birth and deaths registrations
- Property tax
- Water tap connections and charges
- Advertisement tax
- Financial accounting
- Building permissions
- Grievance redressal
- Project and works monitoring system (PROMS)
- Dangerous and offensive trade license
- Assets and inventory
- Court cases monitoring

The NIC, Under the Department of Technology of the Ministry of Communications and Information's Technology, Government of India, has taken the lead in constituting a national level project called "SMART Nagarpalika" wherein all the above subjects have been dealt in-depth with Andhra Pradesh as the pilot State. A detailed systems requirements

specifications (SRS) report has been prepared and the same has been utilized as a basis for developing the software on the above subjects.

National Reservoir Level and Capacity Monitoring System

Reservoir Storage Monitoring System is the software application developed as website for monitoring water storages in major and medium reservoirs of Andhra Pradesh. Irrigation & CAD Department has the overall responsibility of storing and maintaining such information of the status of Reservoirs. Mobile technology is integrated into the software enabling faster communication from the field engineer to the data base of website. SMS update from the field engineer is once in a day during normal situation. During alarming situations, the field engineer will be asked to send SMS and update the database even on hourly basis

Monitoring of reservoir level and its storage capacity has a significant importance in evaluation of water utilization, crop production, hydropower generation and an instrument in planning process. The parameter could be an early warning indicator to the crop production and Hydro power generation of the country. Any significant deviation from the norms could attract attention of the planner and administrator of the country. Covering this aspect under e-governance and dissemination of information over NICNET/Internet is being discussed as an information technology component under the current prevailing technology of Internet.

Water is the key Element in social and economic development of the country, which is becoming a scarce resource due to over-increasing demands of the growing population, Agriculture , Hydropower and Industrial Users. Thus emphasizing the need of monitoring and specific utilization of water resource with appropriate communication technology for its availability, monitoring and management in the real / near-real-time environment. National Informatics Center , Ministry of Information Technology has been providing support to central water commission to monitor the reservoir over the NICNET through its district center and has been monitoring the reservoir and storage capacity of 63 to 70 reservoirs on a weekly/day-to-day basis over NICNET for the last more than 12 years and providing technical support to the various departments engaged in water resources planning including Union Ministry of Agriculture in the strategic crop planning process as an early warning indicator.

Over the period of time better effective technology has come and the model has been revised to provide the complete informatics and administrative control to the state govt. under the NICNET/Internet. With the current available technology of Internet and GUI environment, it has become possible under JAVA and DB2 environment as an Web-Enabled application to evolve a new version to provide support to the state govts., with complete administrative and management control. The information thus collated from the various states can be placed on Internet for general viewing of the various departments of Centre and state govt., and of Planning Commission.

Features & Benefits:

- Trend of reservoir filling/ depletion
- Comparison with the data of previous years
- Basin wise comparison of storage built up from time to time
- Analytic tables bringing out the maximum, minimum and average of annual carry over.
- Storage utilization on annual basis and for the last ten years
- Total live storage

Ekal Sewa Kendra

The project “e-DISHA Ekal Seva Kendra (Common Service Centers)” is an effort towards creating a Citizen Services Network, a way to take the governance to the citizens at their doorstep and hence make it available even at the grass-root level. The key objectives are to improve the quality of life of the people, upgrading the standard of administration, especially in social and public services, and to provide public centered efficient and cost effective governance. The project is seen as a trendsetter in the State and will ensure delivery of services with efficiency, effectiveness and transparency.

Broad Objectives

- To make governance transparent, thereby maximizing citizen interaction with government,
- Improve relationships with citizens by enabling online transactions, and feedback to administration and legislation,
- Reduce the costs of service delivery through reduced duplication of efforts by individuals and departments.
- Improve the quality of delivery of public services; take local knowledge to the world,
- Set-up information kiosks owned and run by local entrepreneurs financially sustainable,
- Extensive separation of functional as well as IT Literacy,
- Provide effective, efficient, timely, transparent, hassle free services to the citizens at their doorsteps,
- Eliminate corruption and middlemen from the process,
- Create knowledge based jobs in the district and extend benefits of ICT to the masses.

Haryana government has established the DLeDCs (District level e-DISHA Centers) in all district mini secretariats in Haryana. These DLeDCs are providing the services, which are strictly in government domain. These services include issue of various certificates, driving license, vehicle

registration, birth and death certificates, passport, and services related to arms licenses etc. The time bound service delivery has resulted in improving the efficiency of delivery of the services and elimination of corruption and middlemen from the process. By providing a wide spectrum of services at a single place has helped in saving citizens from the trouble of running around various departments. These centers are also expected to help in integration of databases of Government departments and organizations. This integration can also force the user departments to carry out process reengineering and standardization in delivery of services. Besides, these centers are creating jobs in the districts for the local IT savvy youths and spreading the utility of Information Technology among the masses. This has also helped in improving the financial health of District Red Cross / IT Societies. The project has been found as one of the best self-sustainable model.

Sachivalaya Vahini

Sachivalaya Vahini is a suite of Letter Monitoring System, File Monitoring System, Court Cases Monitoring System, Document Management System and Disciplinary Enquiry Cases Monitoring System. The objective of this project is to automate all major Office procedures followed in all the departments of Karnataka Government Secretariat.

Letter Monitoring System (LMS): This is a useful package to manage the bulk of letters received in any department. The letters can be moved from desk to desk and even across the departments for actions to be taken, till the letters are filed or disposed. Status of letter like where the letter is pending and for what reason can be known without any time delay. The entire movement of the letter can be traced and action taken at each section or department is made available.

File Monitoring System (FMS): It is a decision support system to monitor, track and help in the speedy disposal of files. Electronic files can be moved from desk to desk and across the departments. Status of file can be known instantaneously all the letters in the file can be viewed. Individually. Section-wise, and department-wise Pendency of files can be obtained.

Court Cases Monitoring System (CCMS): This package is used to manage efficiently the number of cases received, petitioner/respondent details, court orders, cases having hearing date the next day etc. Integration between CCMS and FMS enables case related files to be tracked and status known whenever required.

Document Management System (DMS): This package is an essential tool to track the documents like Circulars, Notification and Government Orders. The system consists of a friendly interface where the users can create the Documents, move the document for approval, scan and upload it. Content search and the specific search provided by this system enable the user to reduce the delay in search the required documents.

Disciplinary Enquiry Cases Monitoring System (DECMS): This package is an essential tool to monitor various enquiry cases initiated by the Department on the government employees. The system consists of a friendly interface where the users can input the details of all the case details, officer details and enquiry details. This application is integrated with the File Monitoring System.

Bhoomi Project

Bhoomi (meaning land) is the project of on-line delivery and management of land records in Karnataka. It provides transparency in land records management with better citizen services and takes discretion away from civil servants at operating levels.

The Revenue Department in Karnataka, with the technical assistance from National Informatics Centre (NIC), Bangalore, has built and operationalized the BHOOMI system throughout the state. The BHOOMI has computerized 20 million records of land ownership of 6.7 million farmers in the state.

BHOOMI has reduced the discretion of public officials by introducing provisions for recording a mutation request online. Farmers can now access the database and are empowered to follow up. In the BHOOMI project, a printed copy of the RTC (Record of Rights, Tenancy and Crops) can be obtained online by providing the name of the owner or plot number at computerized land record kiosks in 177 taluk offices, for a fee of

Rs.15. A second computer screen faces the clients to enable them to see the transaction being performed. A farmer can check the status of a mutation application on Touch Screen Kiosks. If the revenue inspector does not complete the mutation within 45 days, a farmer can now approach a senior officer person with their grievance.

Now, mutation requests are being handled strictly on a first-come-first-served basis eliminating preferential treatment and discretionary powers of the civil servants.

Operators of the computerized system are made accountable for their decisions and actions by using a bio-login system that authenticates every Login through a thumbprint. A log is maintained of all transactions in a session.

The new system has brought about a sea change in the way land records are maintained and administered in the state. The system has not only simplified the process of record keeping but has also provided many collateral benefits. This governance model has proven to be financially self-sustainable. It has become a trendsetter for e-Governance projects in the state as well as other parts of the country.

In the next phase of BHOOMI, the 'LAND RECORDS ON WEB' has been established wherein, all the taluk databases are getting uploaded to a web-enabled central database so as to allow the private agencies to set up the village – level kiosk to download the land records documents at the village and issue to the farmers. In this Private Public Participation (PPP) model, all the stakeholders will be benefited in land records delivery.

Benefits of Bhoomi

- Farmers
 - + Farmers can quickly get their land records from Kiosks and are protected from harassment and extortion.
 - + Reduction in processing time for mutation.
 - + Online tracking of mutation status.
 - + Easy access to Farm Credit.
 - + Ease in case of legal matters.

- Administrators
 - + Ease of maintenance and updation of land records documents.
 - + Quick and easy access to Land records.
 - + Quick and easy access to Land records for analysis purpose.
 - + Ease of monitoring Government Lands.
- Others
 - + For Financial Institutions, Online Farm credit related activities.
 - + Information availability for Private Sector.

IT in Indian Judiciary

- The judiciary is a system of courts that interpret and apply the law. The role of the courts is to decide cases by determining the relevant facts and the relevant law and applying the relevant facts to the relevant law. The Indian Judiciary administers a common law system in which customs, securities, and legislation, all codify the law of the land.
- Technology has proven its role in enhancing efficiency, improving access, as well as encouraging transparency, accountability, and adherence to timelines in dealing with legal matters.
- India has taken a variety of measures to automate processes within the judiciary with an aim to improve efficiency and eliminate the time lost in unproductive work. Some of the initiatives are: easy accessibility to online case records and previous judicial pronouncements, reducing dependency on stenographers by utilizing voice recognition software, usage of video conferencing facilities to increase the reach of courts, case management systems, e-registry of court, automated preparation of cause-lists, phasing out physical records through e-filing and e submission of documents, etc

Judicial application in IT

- In 1990 a project named COURTS (Court Information System) was launched for the benefit of the entire legal community. This project

was commissioned for streamlining registries of the community. This project was commissioned to streamline registries of various courts, Subsequently, all High Courts have been computerized and Web-enabled both locally and nationally through NICNET.

- The following applications have been successfully implemented at the Supreme Court and also 18 High Courts in the country. The end result of these applications has been a lot of convenience, improvement, and speed of legal service for the litigants who are common people of India.

E-Khazana

- In tune with the policy initiative taken up by the Government of Andhra Pradesh for effective utilization of Information Technology as part of the e-Governance project, National Informatics Centre, Hyderabad has taken up online computerization for its Districts Treasury (DTO), Sub Treasury (STO) and Pay and Accounts Offices (PAO) Offices in 330 locations across the state.
- E-Khazana is an online application that takes care of entry-level validation and budget control and pre-audit rules at the Auditor level and finally for the issue of cheque/pass order at the passing level. After reconciliation with the bank, monthly accounts will be generated for submission to Accountant General.
- The Administrators' role is very important in this application as he will be responsible for
 - Assigning the roles.
 - Watching budget expenditure. Head of accounts, and
 - Drawing and disbursing officer.
- It is an intranet application that works on Linux/Windows platform with backend as postage SQL 7.3 and front-end is PHP 4.1 (Hypertext Pre Processor).

DGFT

For effective and efficient e-Governance where the licenses are issued electronically by using of IT for web based delivery service in the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT). Now a days complete licensing procedure is dealing through electronically i.e. Exporter/Importer apply electronically to get the Importer Exporter Code(IEC) , submitting the fees as well as necessary documents electronically and received the IEC electronically. Trading Community is also availing the Online facility to submit the application for any licensing scheme, depositing the licensing fees, enclosing the required document from their end. The official procedure is also automated like initiating the note sheet, generating the ecom number, consolation of license fees and issuing the license to the exporter

NIC-DGFT has played catalytic & significant role in implementing e-Governance project in the DGFT with an aim to leverage IT for transparency and better governance. ,Keeping in view the object Directorate General of Foreign Trade had set up an online trade facilitation system. It containing EDI interfaces with the Trade Partners and all concerned in the value chain have been established. Customs, Banks, Trade and Industry and other Government Agencies are the part of this mechanism. Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) is core driver for facilitating international trade and one of the key initiatives is electronic transmission of foreign exchange realization details on exports by banks on a daily basis under the Electronic Bank realization Certificate (e-BRC) initiative. Exporter will not be required to make any request to Bank for issuance of Bank export and Realization Certificate (BRC). This will establish a seamless EDI connectivity amongst DGFT, Banks and Exporters. This is significant step to reduce transaction cost to the exporters.

OBJECTIVES OF DGFT

The major objectives of DGFT are as follows:

1. Effective and efficient e-governance services
2. Globally accessibility of the e-services.

3. Maintaining the integrity of public services.
4. Reduction in transaction cost and time.
5. Elimination of fraud practice of trade and industry
6. Physical visit of exporter of the office reduced to minimum.
7. Publishing of Monthly license Bulletin.
8. Implementation of single common document for the trade.
9. To move the DGFT in paperless environment

E-Seva

The Project 'e-seva' (e-services) began in the district of West Godavari that falls in the State of Andhra Pradesh. The Project is a tool to bridge the digital divide and has used ICT for providing access to various citizen-to-citizen (C2C) and citizen-to-government (C2G) services to the people living in rural areas. Under this Project, web enabled rural kiosks (centres) have been established in the villages.

Project Objective: Establish a sustainable service delivery model, wherein the government services are delivered to the citizen through a single window system, accessible at close proximity.

Value to Citizen: (a) Services delivery centre located at close proximity to the citizen thereby enhancing convenience (b) Reduce citizen interaction with the Government functionary / office for a service and c) Evolve these e-Seva centre into single stop shops for other routine citizen needs.

Services**Charges**

Issue of Certificates: Caste, Income, Residence, Integrated	Rs. 10
Posting of Grievances	Rs. 5
Download of applications/ static information like mandi rates	Rs. 2
Acceptance of electricity bill payments	Rs. 2 per bill
Computer aided education in collaboration with Azim Premji Foundation by designating the local schools to the collocated e-Seva center	Rs. 2 per child per month
Co-location of general facilities like, photocopying, fax/STD/ISD, internet Browsing lamination and binding works etc to augment the revenue of the center	

The unique thing about these centres is:

- they are run and managed by the women self help groups; and
- they have been able to position the rural women as information leaders to help bridge the gender divide.

The Project, thus, provides information leadership to these groups and helps them act as change agents and makes it possible for them to grow in strength and stature with the Project. These rural kiosks or centres are run on a district portal (<http://www.westgodavari.org>) that allows access to various citizen centric services. The computers in the kiosks are on a district wide network (a hybrid of dial up 802.11 and WiLL) helping kiosks interact with the district server hosting the local portal. To save on the

networking cost, the Project has developed a unique synchronization tool that allows the kiosks to work offline and allows the databases to be periodically synchronized in minimal time. Besides, the horizontal portal is put on the global World Wide Web and allows vertical integration with the expanding frontiers of universal knowledge and information bank.

The Project uses the opportunities that the ICT offers in empowering the citizens and allows e-enabled education inputs to children to build their creative insights. It offers a wide range of services from the issuance of various certificates to getting information about various programmes and also networking citizens and allowing them the flexibility and convenience of mutually beneficial transactions. It also allows access to previously marginalised communities and helps in bridging the existing information gaps. It is, therefore, a step towards digital unite.

- the Project has proved that by combining the resources and energies of groups and individuals to pursue self-employment, a viable low cost alternative to bring in the benefits of ICT can be created and sustained;
- the initiative has demonstrated that such projects can bring in transparency in the functioning of the administration to a plausible extent and allow an independent domain and space to the citizens to interact with government;
- such a Project can address a wide range of services that can bring additional returns to the operator and provide opportunities to the citizens to become part of the tech savvy world; and
- such a Project requires a strong will at the highest level, political and administrative, so as to overcome the pressures and obstacles of vested interests.

E-Panchayat

E-Panchayat is a software product conceptualized, designed and developed by National Information Centre, Hyderabad, Andhra Pradesh, as a part of its E-governance initiatives. E-Panchayat has been designed taking into consideration all the information and knowledge management

requirements in a Gram Panchayat. The 1992 Panchayat raj Act of Government of India, and the Success stories of the Gram Panchayats in various states in the country have been taken into consideration while developing e-Panchayat. The Government Order issued by the Government of Andhra Pradesh regarding the village secretariat and the functions of the village secretary besides the elected representatives of the gram Panchayat are all considered in this package. Thus e-Panchayat fits well into gram panchayat are all considered in this package. Thus e-Panchayat fits well into the information systems at gram panchayat level. The e-Panchayat fits well into the information systems at gram panchayat level. The software is web enabled, and citizen-centric. Therefore, even with less overheads the village level functionaries and the citizens are envisaged to benefit by e-Panchayat.

E-Panchayat comprises nearly 30 main modules, and Nearly 150 sub-modules, in line with the 30 sectoral functions of the gram panchayats. Ramachandrapuram Gram Panchayat (Merdak District, Near Hyderabad, Andhra Pradesh) was taken as panchayat for e-Panchayat.

Gram Panchayat Administration

The module facilitates provision of following information services:

- Minutes of meetings
- Schedules of Gram Sabhas
- Agenda update
- Certificates, Licences
- Bill payments
- Attendance monitoring of the Panchayat functionaries
- Gram Panchyat Meeting Management
- Gram Panchayat Cleanliness Monitoring
- Registration of Births/Deaths/Marriage Etc.
- SGSU works monitoring, issue of trade licences
- Pension schemes management system

- Self-help group and other villagers welfare schemes management system.
- Assets management, property tax assessment and management.
- Property lost/found reporting system
- Encroachments checking and monitoring module
- Government orders searching and retrieval system
- Village statistics maintenance and reporting system
- Intensive sanitation management information system.

The e-panchayat programme aims at equipping rural India with updated information online and thus, enables gram panchayats to be computerised. For this purpose, the e-Panchayat MMP is aimed at automating internal work flow processes of approximately 2.45 lakh panchayats across India. This will cover approximately 30 lakh elected members and several lakh PRI functionaries. Under the e-Panchayat Mission, the government plans to use ICT for:

- Automation of internal workflow processes of panchayats.
- Improving delivery of services to citizens.
- Capacity building of panchayat representatives and officials.
- Social auditing.
- Transparency, accountability, efficiency and RTI(Right to Information) compliance of panchayats.
- Improving governance of the local self-government by ensuring people's participation in decision-making.

Benefits of e-panchayat mission

In a state where the gram panchayat has been able to fully adopt the e panchayat modus operandi, all the data and information about gram panchayats could be easily accessed through the internet. In states like Andhra Pradesh and Goa, where the e panchayat programme has been implemented to some extent, citizens can avail of certain facilities online. These include issuance of birth and death certificates, property tax, pension benefits, subsidy benefits, e-health care, e-learning and e-agricultural extension services, etc.

General Information Services of National Informatics Centre

The primary mission of the National Infrastructure Commission (NIC) is to coordinate, carry out, and offer assistance for all of the information technology-based initiatives that are run by the federal government, the governments of the states, and any other government entities.

The National Informatics Centre (NIC) was initially established in 1976 by Late N Shesagiri under the Electronics Commission of India. It was subsequently transferred under the then Planning Commission of India and eventually came under the jurisdiction of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. Additional Secretary Late N Shesagiri is credited with being the first person in India to implement a network system known as NICNET. It is the technological partner of the Government of India and is recognized for assisting the Indian government in embracing information technology in the 1990s. Additionally, it has assisted in the distribution of e-governance to the general public.

For the fiscal year 2018–19, it operated with an annual budget of 11.5 billion yen, which is equivalent to \$150 million USD. The majority of this is allocated to providing free services to various departments within the government.

Following the establishment of the Centre for Smart Governance (CSG) by the central government of India in May 2019, state governments in India have been given the directive to seek advice from the CSG for any IT initiatives on which they had previously required advice from the NIC and private enterprises. Some people claim that government sources have said that “NIC is said to be unable to scale up.” However, the reality is that some vested interests want to curtail the role of NIC in the Indian IT arena, and Rajeev Chawla, Additional Chief Secretary (e-Governance), was quoted as saying that “CSG will be an analogue to NIC.”

NICNET

Through its Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Network, known as NICNET, the National Informatics Centre (NIC) has established institutional linkages with all of the Ministries and Departments of the Central Government, as well as those of the State Governments, Union Territories, and District administrations of the country.

The National Information and Communications Network (NICNET) is a satellite-based wide area network and covers the entire country (WAN).

The National Informatics Centre (NIC) has been instrumental in steering e-Governance applications in Government Ministries and Departments at the Centre, States, Districts, and Block levels through its use of NICNET. This has enabled an improvement in the quality of government services, increased transparency, promoted decentralized planning and management, and led to improved responsiveness to the needs of the people of India.

Direct peering between NICNET and BSNL, PGCIL, and Railtel has been finished in both Delhi and Hyderabad. This was done to save bandwidth on the internet and to provide speedier access to each other's networks and data centers. The establishment of peering relationships with Google, Microsoft, and the Akamai Content Delivery Network has made it possible to have faster access to Google's services as well as other significant international websites.

The reorganization of the video conferencing network has made it possible to reduce the amount of time that is wasted waiting and to successfully manage large-scale important video conferences, such as the PRAGATI of the Honorable Prime Minister and the GST Council Meetings presided over by the Honorable Finance Minister, amongst others.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology in India oversees the operations of the National Informatics Centre (NIC), which is an Indian government entity (MeitY). The NIC enables the delivery of government services to citizens and is a pioneer in the initiatives of Digital India by providing infrastructure, IT Consultancy, and IT Services to Central Government Departments and State Governments. These services include

but are not limited to, architecting design, development, and implementation of IT Systems.

PRAJA

Researching people in the rural areas, Praja is a concept of providing all government and allied services to the people in the district and mandal (for Block) level. This unique experiment taken up for the first time in West Godavari District of Andhra Pradesh was coordinated by the District Collector, * West Godavari, technically supported by National Informatics Centre, West Godavari District.

The Project Praja (The Citizens) is an effort to bring government close to the people empowering them through IT. In other words, it makes government more accessible to the people. It is an effort to delivery various G2C and C2C services to the citizens in rural areas. The project opens web-enabled rural kiosks termed Praja Seva Kendrams at the mandal level and also at village level. The fully computerized Praja Seva Kendrams are on a district wide network connected through the dial up circuits and interact with the district server acting as a remote access server. This project has been implemented in West Godavari District of Andhra Pradesh by the District Collector. The technical responsibility in terms of network support and all software development, support and coordination has been provided by National Informatics Centre (NIC), West Godavari District Centre, Eluru, Andhra Pradesh.

The Praja Seva Kendram runs a district portal Centre, Eluru, Andhra Pradesh, citizen centric services. These services range from the issuance of various certificates to getting information about various programs and also go to the extent of networking citizens to each other and allow them the flexibility and extent of networking citizens to each other and allow them the flexibility and convenience of mutually beneficial transactions. The horizontal portal is eventually put on the global World Wide Web and thus it allows vertical integration with the expanding frontiers of universal

knowledge and information bank. The project allows access to hitherto marginalized communities and therefore helps bridge the existing information gaps and is a step towards digital unit. One unique thing about this digital unite experiment is that many of these Kendrams are run by the women self-help groups, a movement that has been gaining grounds by the day in this district. Many of the Praja Seva Kendrams are run as self-employment units and are manned by unemployed youth from CMEY¹ and PMGRY² beneficiary groups. The project would thus provide Information Leadership to these groups and would help them act as change agents and would make it possible for them to grow in strength and stature along with the project. As a result, the self-help groups and strength and stature along with the project. As a result, the self-help groups and CMEY and PMGRY would draw strength from the project while they would buttress the project with their existing strength, a win-win situation for the twosome.

There is also a myth under circulation that the IT solution is anti-poor and is an unaffordable luxury to nations like India. The digital divide is said to be inevitable. Once has to only realize that IT is only a tool that influence the objective and if the objectives is to make the system more transparent, open and accountable, there is no way it can be anti-poor. Most of the rural areas suffer on account of lack of right information regarding the markets, products, agriculture, health, weather, education, etc. and if all this can rural areas suffer on account of lack right information regarding the markets, products, agriculture, health, weather, education, etc and if all this can be addressed though connectivity and IT, a sea change can be brought in the conditions of the rural communities. This is why creation of a knowledge and information economy can bring in more opportunities and thereby prosperity to the impoverished areas. The project recognizes this fact and envisages that all the village can become knowledge hubs and gain symbiotically from each other and derive benefits from the global networks.

Services Offered

The kind of service offered through this project are described now

- ✓ Online Filing of Complaints and Grievance
- ✓ Online Application Registration
- ✓ Issuance of certificates
- ✓ Issuance of Land Records
- ✓ Online Auctions and Biddings
- ✓ Online Mandle (Market) Rates
- ✓ Payment of Dues
- ✓ Easy Access to Information
- ✓ Matrimonial Services
- ✓ Online Civil Supplies Allotment
- ✓ Tele Medicine
- ✓ Tele Agriculture
- ✓ Consumables Management
- ✓ Forms Download
- ✓ E-Education

Praja Rural E-Seva Project of West Godavari District of Andhra Pradesh, we learnt about the various services from the Government offices that can be carried to the people's by people participation. Even through this means additional cost to the people, it is still a successful service especially in terms of its ease of accountability and utility for common people especially in terms of its ease of accountability and utility for common people in the villages. In addition to providing government services this project encourage rural e-commerce and rural cyber forms in the villages. This project has been emulated by other districts of Andhra Pradesh and a Statewide rollout plan for 6000 Rural Service Delivery Points (RSDPs) by connecting the telephone booths into Kiosks is in the pipeline.

E-governance initiative in USA

The President of the United States, Mr. George W. Bush had issued President's Management Agenda (PMA) for E-Government in the US in 2001. This document laid down clearly the policy, challenges, strategies, direction and future implementation plan along with past achievements in e-governance activity in the US, The details of 24 cross agency e-government initiatives and other related efforts also are given in the documents. An e-government task force was also set up to review these 24 initiatives.

Recognizing clearly the vital importance of e-governance initiatives, the Agenda in July 2001 aimed at making better use of ICT (Information and Communication Technology) investments to eliminate the massive but wasteful federal* government expenditure running into billions of dollars, reduce governments paper work burden on citizens and business, and improve government responses time to citizens from weeks to minutes, Very important, a key goal was set to reduce the time taken by citizens to three click on the internet' to access any government information or service. The agenda identifies internet' to access any government information or service. The agenda identifies three governing principles of e-government:

- Citizen centric, instead of government centric
- Result oriented, instead of procedure oriented
- Market based, instead of regulation based.

Agendas for E-Governance

The Federal Enterprise Architecture for E-Governance

The agenda for e-governance brought out the need for Federal Enterprise

Architecture (FEA) – a comprehensive view of what government organizations does, how does it do and how IT supports it. The FEA is

business focused framework that provide the office of Management and Budget (OMB), which is the agency responsible for FEA and the Federal Agencies with a methodology to monitor, analyze and control federal investments is IT. The FEA enable horizontal (Cross Federal) and vertical (Federal, State and Local government) collaboration and communications with respect to IT investments.

Implementation of President's Management Agenda

The e-governance initiative will enable implementation of various parts of Presents Management Agenda (PMA):

Budget and performance integration, strategic management of human resources, competitive procurement of services and bidding, and improved financial performance. E-payroll, e-training, (e-learning), e-clearance, and e-procurement.

Performance Measurement in E-Governance Implementations

A quarterly scoreboard is used to monitor the performance of various federal agencies engaged in e-governance implementation in their respective departmental activities, Standard requirements require the federal agencies to fulfill at least three of the following criteria:

1. Integration of citizen's one-stop service delivery through Fistsgov.gov and also call centers or service centers.
2. Minimization of burden on business by re-using data previously collected or using XML to receive transmission and data
3. Inter governmental deployment of e-grants or geospatial outsourcing
4. Achieving productivity, improvements by implementing Customers Relationship Management (CRM), Supply Change Management (SCM), Knowledge Management (KM), and Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP).

A federal Agency will be given "Green" Score if it meets all the above standards for success. "Yellow" score will be given if the agency had partially achieved this and "red" will be given if there exist significant gaps between the goals set and ground reality in the agency.

A number of agencies have shown improvement from red to yellow such as Department of Education, Department of Energy, and Department of External Affairs. NSF (National Science Foundation) upgrading itself from yellow to green.

Subsequently, 'Green' was given to a number of agencies such as Department of Housing and Urban Development, Department of Interior.

Department of Justice, Department of Agriculture, Department of Labor, Department of Transportation, Environmental Protection Agency, NASA, NSP, and Social Security Administration.

E-Government Projects, Portfolios or Categories

The e-government projects are organized into portfolio or categories as defined by the customers requirements served. The following categories and described in items of their goals

Government to Citizens (G2C)

The objectives of (G2C) category of services is to provide one stop online access to governmental information and services to individual citizens. In this the citizens are expected to access and obtain any information promptly. For examples Govbenefits.gov portal provides instantaneous access to citizens regarding information about all government program and service through a single web site within three clicks.

Government to Business (G2B)

The objective of (G2B) portfolio or category of services is to provide one stop access to business community on information pertaining to all government procedures, and rules, and regulations pertaining to them. The previous practice was making business submit multipole forms of data

multiple times to different government agencies. The objective is to provide a single window interface with the government, including all departments.

The government should re-use data submitted only once for different multiple purpose. This regulates appropriate interpretation of the same data entered in various formats. The deployment of a more effective technology will help streamline the myriad reporting requirements, as well as facilitate a more efficient means for business to interact with the government. Citizens or Business can easily find rules and regulations at www.regulation.gov even without the help of an attorney or a lawyer.

Government to Government (G2G)

The objectives of this portfolio is to enable different wings of the federal government or the State government interact effectively with each other. To achieve this, the objective of the Federal Government is to make it easier for states. So meet the reporting request while prompting the use of performance monitoring. This will definitely result in substantial saving for the State governments. The data delivery will be more accurate and time saving. An example in this direction will be Home Land Security Initiative, a security portal that will improve disaster management process, by simplifying and unifying the interaction between various government agencies as Federal, state and Local administration as well as Local Safety and Security Organizations and Personnel.

Internal Efficiency and Effectiveness (IEE)

The objectives of this portfolio is to modernize and improve the efficiency of internal process of the Federal Government in order to reduce the cost of internal administration of the Federal Government. IEE portfolio focus is to apply the best IT practice and also the best management practice into the Federal Government operation. This aims at introducing the industry's latest best practices of Supply chain Management, Financial Managements Knowledge Management into the regular government functioning – a highly ambitious aim. However, these techniques, if introduced into the

government, can revolutionize the Government functioning, speed and efficiency, eliminate all delays and improve employees satisfaction. This also includes introduction of e-learning techniques into government staff training. The e-training portal www.golearn.gov is capable of providing enhance access to high quality training and competency development for Federal Government employees.

The authentication module will deliver a solution that ensure employees authentication using multiple technologies while, at the same time protecting and respecting, the privacy and security of the users. In order words authentication provides the trust and security required for making e-government initiatives successful.

E-government accomplishment in USA

The following e-governance projects throw light on the e-governance initiatives in USA:

- i. FirstGov.gov. First Gov.gov is an American citizens' getaway to about 200 million pages of information distributed in more than 22,000 Federal and State government web sites. Named as one of the "Top 50 most incredibly useful web sites" in the entire world by Yahoo in 2002, this service is designed to provide government service within three clicks. The new "Three clicks" strategy has drawn dramatically large number of hits up to 30 millions.
- ii. Volunteer.gov. The site enables American citizens interested in volunteering to work for more than 1,00,000 opening available in government hospital and other Federal organizations.
- iii. Recreation.gov. The site provides citizens online access to more than the total 22,000 National parks and Recreation areas of US.

- iv. Gov.Benefits.gov. This site provides access to more than 400 government programs of benefits. It receives about 5,00,000 visitors per month and is listed as a 'Hot site'.
- v. IRS free filing. Over 80 million Americans can file their taxes online for free.
- vi. Integrated Acquisition Environment (IAE). This site provides information on past performance of contractors and also Federal technical data on acquisition material.
- vii. Business.Law.gov. The site is designed to provide small business quick access to legal and regulation information tools of compliance, the ability to perform online transactions and business related information of the government.
- viii. Regulation.gov. The site provides data on all government regulations. This has received 2.6 millions hits in January 2003.
- ix. GoLearn.gov. This is the world' most visited e-training initiative site with more than 6 millions hits, with information over 2000 e-training courses, e-books and carrier development resources. This site has more than 45,000 registered users who can receive training at negligible cost.
- x. E-payroll. This is a consolidated payroll from 22 different centers. More than a billion dollars re saved with this site.
- xi. E-clearance. This is an integrated database that will help security clearance process. 99% of all security clearance are available electronically.

Conclusion

This case study provides a clear but brief view of the IT enablement taking place in the Government of USA. The web based services offered by government of USA to the citizens are detailed in this case study.

E-governance in China

Introduction

E-government has made good achievements in China and played a major role in improving administrative institutions and provision of public services. In China, the applications of e-government increased since 2001. The application of e-government in China was intended, in part, to accelerate the government's pace of implementing and using information and communications technologies (ICTs) to improve administrative efficiency and effectiveness and, through this administrative reform, to promote economic development and the administrative capacity (Hongguan Tiaokong Nengli) of the central government in China.

In China, the focus of e-government has mainly been on administrative reform (Xingzheng Guanli Tizhi Gaige) which has to enter into other areas. As a consequence of a deeply centralized and often inefficient administrative management system, China has faced critical problems including over bloated structures, overstaffing, confusion between government and enterprise management, and the often unhelpful intervention of the central government in the economy (Lianjie, Chung & Thorson, 2005).

In an age of information expansion, the Chinese government has actively encouraged and invested in the growth of the Internet to capture the technology's vast commercial potential while exerting state control over the ways that this "network of networks" is accessed by Chinese citizens. The central government has encouraged the competing state-owned telecommunications providers, such as China Telecom, China Unicom, China Mobile, China Netcom, JiTong Communications Company, and China Railway Telecom, to build their own networks. Faced with the potential political or social challenges that the new medium may bring, the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) has utilized multiple control strategies to maximize official authority.

The Hi-tech E-park

The Zhongguancun Science Park (ZSP), the biggest National Science Park in China was established in 1988, in the North-Western part of Beijing City, the capital of People's Republic of China.

The Park spans over 100 square kilometers comprising of more than 600 companies in Hi-tech areas as IT, Biology, Medicine, etc. Large multinationals such as IBM, Microsoft, Lucent, HP, and Epson have R & D institution here. Thirty-nine prominent universities and colleges such as Beijing University and Tsinghua University are also located within the park.

The ZSP Administrative committee which is the local government body that regulates, controls and administers all activities in the park has twelve departments, each looking after functions as Company Certification, Taxation and the like.

The administration of the park formed a strategic partnership with a local private application software company, Beijing Beauty Bearrl limited which started the system study and completed the software development by the end of the year 2000.

In the new system the central database and web site allow data sharing and workflow integration among all the departments. Thus the administration functions are a single integrated body showing only one face to the public. The system includes five functions, all accessed from the web site homepage of the web site.

The following are the five functions of the system.

(i) E-application

This is a web based software that provides the applicants with all form and documents required, along with rules and regulations, and also procedure for setting up a company in the Park. After login with the user ID and password the users can fill up the files directly on the web or download the forms, fill them up on the computer, and upload them

into the web. The form will depend upon the nature of the company. Almost instantaneously, the ZSP Administration committee receives the applications and beings approval procedures online. Two or three layers of approval are processed by the Administration. In each layer the Administration sends its comments/feedback/objectives to the company online. The company will make corrections online and submit immediately.

This process of submitting, correcting and resubmitting will proceed until the final approval is granted online. The applicant company will then take a printout of the approval file and submit all the original documents to ZSP verification, the licence certificate will be issued to the applicant.

As can be seen above only once there is a physical visit by the applicant to the administration office, i.e. for the final approval. Till then all the steps are automatically online.

(ii) E-registration

After obtaining approval for establishing the company, additional information is required to be provided to the administration in order to register with other department of ZSP. e.g. Statistical Bureau, Finance Bureau and Quality Control Bureau. All these now can be done through Internet.

(iii) E-reporting

Every company has to report every month to the ZSP administrations and other appropriate governments offices various information parameters such as the company revenue, tax, costs, cash flow, etc. All these can now be done online.

(iv) E-administrations

Other administrative information leading to tax cut, tax assessment, and subsidiaries, are all calculated on the web in the new systems. Financial and other information also will be submitted by the companies online.

(v) E-consulting

Government official can provide online interactive consultation regarding any of these procedures, and replies can be sent by Fax and Email.

Other features

- a.** 'Red light' –reminder system. The new system keeps track of all applications and remind the offices of how much delay and pendency is there for a given application. The 'reminder light' is clearly seen on the screen of official desk top system. First day the green light is shown. The second day yellow light and third day red light indicating the official has not completed the work on time. When the light turns red a report of delay/pendency is automatically sent to the superior officer.
- b.** Monitoring System. Superior officers can go directly to their staff member's virtual office and check and review their work
- c.** Statistics and query monitoring System. Statistics such as number and salary of staff, sales revenue and costs are monitored. Ad hoc, queries are also available.
- d.** OCR, VCR and HWCR. Optical character Recognition (OCR), voice character, Reorganization (VCR), and Hand Writing Character Recognition (HWCR) are available for data entry help in Chinese language.

Benefits

A very impressive benefits list of the system can be made, Since operationalization in August 2000 several hundred thousands people have

visited up to 5000. Several thousands of companies' licence and approvals of various kinds have been issued through the systems. They have all submitted their financial returns through the online web based system. Other benefits are, transparency, speed, and efficiency, added to interactive, session.

E-governance in Brazil

Introduction

Brazil has been taking steps towards digital government to ensure that public policies and services are more inclusive, convenient and designed to meet citizens' needs.

Brazil has streamlined its government bureaucracy and given citizens access to e-government services by creating a chain of one-stop-shops that put state services in the same place.

Poupatempo – which means Timesaver – began life in 1997, with one unit in Sao Paulo. Now, it's expanded across the state with 28 one-stop-shops, which in 2010 provided services to more than 32 million people.

Each store contains offices for dozens of government agencies and specialized rooms where citizens can access online services – called e-poupatempo – streamlining the process of obtaining state documents, processing tax or settling disputes, among other needs. The project has seen an enthusiastic take-up: by 2006, some 75,000 people were served by Poupatempo every day. The customer satisfaction rate was also high, and service at each of the posts was rated at good or very good by more than 94% of respondents.

While the broader chain of one-stop-shops was primarily a government endeavour, with partners from across the public sector, a private partnership helped set up e-Poupatempo. This component, which over time became one of the most important in the projects, integrates online services into the one-stop-shops, was based on a partnership with private tech companies. Rooms dedicated to e-government were initially set up in one centre through a partnership with technology firms Intel and AMD, and are now available at all one-stop-shops. Citizens can access most of the services available at Poupatempo online, and they're assisted with using the computers by attendants trained by the centres.

The project is part of Intel's strategy for integrating technology into government services and encouraging citizens to go online services rather than using face-to-face appointments when dealing with the government. A key to the project's success was that reforming citizen's experience of

services didn't involved a rehaul of the government bureaucracy itself – providing people access using online connections and a more streamlined, accessible and well-trained staff was enough.

The services delivered using a public private partnership, however, were more expensive: costing the state an average of \$1.43 for each person compared to \$1.29.

The Timesaver initiative rectified some debilitating problems for Brazilian bureaucracy. In the past, government services weren't centralized and offices for passport services, driving licenses, paying public utilities and negotiating dispute charges were scattered across cities. Negotiating the bureaucracies was challenging for ordinary people, waiting times were long, staff were notoriously unhelpful, and customers felts that they weren't properly informed of what was required from them. The situation was so chaotic that in some government offices a black market had evolved for accessible spots in the queue.

E-poupatempo is also being rolled out through the Poupatempo Model, a mobile unit where citizens can access services online. Seven customized trucks and buses are in operation, serving areas of the city that may otherwise be difficult to access.

E-governance in Sri Lanka

Evolution of e-Governance concept in Sri Lanka can be traced back to 1983 because the Government of Sri Lanka for the first time recognized its obligation for ICT development by creating the National Computer Policy of 1983. The Information and Communication Technology Act No. 27 of 2003 came into existence in 2003 and the Information and Communication Technology Agency of Sri Lanka was established. In 2004, "e-Sri Lanka Development Project" was initiated. It included information infrastructure building, improvement of human resources in ICT, citizen-specific service delivery, creating a modern government using ICT for social and economic development, and endorsing Sri Lanka as a destination for ICT. The e-Sri Lanka initiative expects to use ICT to develop the economy of Sri Lanka by reducing poverty and thus improving the quality of life of its citizens.

As indicated in e-Government Policy, a publication released by the Information Communication Technology Agency of Sri Lanka (ICTA) in 2010, the objectives of e-Government are the following.

- Provide more convenient and better services to citizens
- Improve participation of clients
- Use of social media to ensure better service provision
- Develop better relationships with clients
- Enhance good governance

Kothamale Community Radio Internet Project

The Kothamale Radio/Internet project in Sri Lanka is an experiment in attempting to bridge the digital divide. The purpose of the Kothamale Radio/Internet project was to test and demonstrate an access model that reduce the digital divide/barriers and empower the marginalized communities in rural areas, by enabling them to enjoy benefits from ICT, to expand their knowledge base and thereby support their efforts to tackle the developmental problems themselves.

The project uses community radio as an interface between the rural community and internet through a pioneering "Radio Browsing" model. thereby introducing an indirect mass access to cyber space through a daily one-hour radio program on an interaction mode.

Example of radio/Internet Browsing

Following are some examples which describe the utility of Internet access at Kothamale community radio.

1. The village baker found various recipes from the internet to improve the quality of his products.
2. The village blacksmith browsed web sites to know more about modern implements for his trade.
3. An elderly woman visited a web site of Buddhist sacred laces of India, and was very pleased as it was beyond her financial resources to visit the sacred place in persons.
4. Farmer accessed the internet to find information of improved techniques of tomato growing and storage.

5. A group of local products used the Internet and found export possibilities for "Jaggery," a local product of palm.
6. An English teacher of the local school often visited with his class and downloaded lessons and games for learning English.
7. Many community members opened e-mail accounts at the radio station and used the facility to exchange e-mail with their relatives working abroad.
8. A listener visited the site to find information on bamboo craft and organized an exhibition of improved bamboo products, which he produced with the new knowledge acquired from the Internet sources.
9. A group of young people used Internet sources and networked with an organization abroad to form an environment NGO. They then mobilized resources to launch a reforestation program in their community.
10. Radio provide location-specific weather report (for the coming four days) by reading real-time satellite picture and weather forecast data from Internet sites.

Benefits

Following are the noted benefits of this project:

- An increased level of awareness concerning the benefits of ICTs.
- New livelihood ideas and model projects
- A high level of community participation and increased involvement of youth.
- Enthusiasm of local political leadership and a resurgence of commitment to the communities they serve; more animated discussion about knowledge and expansion of the communities' knowledge base.